

C1

Lead Centre: what we need from you to go live

The Lead Centre is built and deployed. Every enquiry — WhatsApp, phone, SMS, email — lands as one thread, with the pipeline, the quote and the porting status beside it. It is currently running on demo data. This is everything we need from you to switch it onto real enquiries.

C1 CLEARANCE · PREPARED FOR SAM AND DAN · SEPTEMBER 2026

BUILT & DEPLOYED	RUNNING ON	CHANNELS CONNECTED	BLOCKING ITEMS
Yes	Demo data	None yet	7

Why nothing real can arrive yet

The inbox is wired to Aircall, which carries voice, SMS and WhatsApp on one number. Until the Aircall credentials below are set, the webhook refuses every incoming event and replies are marked *“recorded locally — not sent”* rather than pretending to have been delivered. That is deliberate: a half-configured inbox that silently drops enquiries would be worse than one that plainly says it is off.

1 Aircall access **BLOCKING**

Nothing reaches the Lead Centre without these five. They take minutes to produce once someone with Aircall admin is at a keyboard.

WHAT WE NEED	WHY / WHERE IT COMES FROM	WHO
Aircall plan with the WhatsApp add-on	WhatsApp in Aircall is a paid add-on. Without it, WhatsApp cannot be a channel and the van QR code has nowhere to land.	Sam

WHAT WE NEED	WHY / WHERE IT COMES FROM	WHO
AIRCALL_API_ID and AIRCALL_API_TOKEN	Aircall Dashboard → Integrations → API Keys. Lets us send replies out from the inbox.	Sam or Dan
AIRCALL_NUMBER_ID	The numeric id of the number carrying WhatsApp and SMS. Visible in the Aircall dashboard URL for that number.	Sam or Dan
A webhook pointed at us	Aircall → Integrations → Webhooks, URL <code>https://c1-lead-centre-production.up.railway.app/api/webhooks/aircall</code> . Subscribe to <code>call.ended</code> , <code>call.voicemail_left</code> , <code>call.comm_assets_generated</code> , <code>message.received</code> , <code>message.sent</code> .	Sam or Dan
AIRCALL_WEBHOOK_TOKEN	The shared secret set on that webhook. We verify every event against it, so nobody can post fake leads into the inbox.	Sam or Dan

2 WhatsApp on the van number BLOCKING

The van QR code and the printed leaflets resolve to `wa.me/447440517077`. That number cannot change without re-signwriting the van and reprinting the leaflets, so it has to be handled carefully.

On not wanting the Facebook route

Half of that is achievable and half is not, so it is worth being exact.

Unavoidable: getting WhatsApp messages into a shared inbox — any shared inbox, from any supplier — runs on Meta's WhatsApp Business Platform. Every provider (Aircall, Twilio, 360dialog, Wati, Respond.io) sits on top of it. There is no supplier who can bypass Meta, so a Meta business account has to exist.

Probably avoidable: the part you are calling hard — full *business verification*, with company documents. Meta caps an **unverified** account at 250 conversations per 24 hours, but that cap applies only to conversations *the business starts*. Meta's own documentation says limits are counted “outside of a customer service window”, so when a customer messages you first — which is exactly what a van QR scan is — your replies do not count against it.

So for how C1 actually works, unverified is very likely enough. The cap would only bite if you started messaging people who had not contacted you first, which is not what the Lead Centre does.

WHAT WE NEED	WHY / WHERE IT COMES FROM	WHO
A Meta business account (unverified is fine)	Required by every WhatsApp provider. Setting one up is a form, not a document submission — the document-heavy step is verification, which on current evidence you can skip.	Sam
A decision on provider	Aircall's WhatsApp add-on requires a verified portfolio, so if you want to stay unverified we should use a different provider for WhatsApp and keep Aircall for calls. Several handle the Meta setup on your behalf, which removes most of the work you are trying to avoid.	Sam + us
Go-ahead to connect 07440 517077	The number can be connected without porting it first, so the van QR keeps working throughout.	Sam

WHAT WE NEED	WHY / WHERE IT COMES FROM	WHO
Anything worth keeping from the current WhatsApp history	Connecting the number to any API provider removes access to its previous WhatsApp message history . Export or screenshot anything needed first, because it does not come back.	Sam or Dan
Who administers the WhatsApp Business app today	That account has to be released from the number. We need whoever's phone it currently lives on.	Sam

Please do not let anyone sell you an “unofficial” WhatsApp integration

Tools that drive WhatsApp by logging in as a normal user, without Meta, do exist. They breach WhatsApp's terms and get numbers banned. A ban on 07440 517077 would take the van, the leaflets and your main lead source down at once, with no appeal. Not worth it at any price.

3 The numbers BEFORE GO-LIVE

WHAT WE NEED	WHY / WHERE IT COMES FROM	WHO
The real porting status	The app currently shows an invented “Day 6 of 21, estimated 1 September”. We need the actual PAC submission date and expected cutover so the screen tells the truth.	Sam
Lycamobile PAC code + proof of address	Needed to port voice for 07440 517077. If it has already been submitted, just tell us when.	Sam
Which number becomes the Aircall number	You mentioned calls will come in on an Aircall number. The van prints 0330 133 9144 — so is that number moving to Aircall, or is a brand-new Aircall number being used? If it is new, the number on the van is wrong from day one, which matters more than the WhatsApp side.	Sam

4 People and access BEFORE GO-LIVE

WHAT WE NEED	WHY / WHERE IT COMES FROM	WHO
The real staff list	Full name, email and whether each person is an admin or standard staff. Right now there are two invented accounts.	Sam
A real password policy	Everyone currently shares one demo password, and the site is on a public URL. We need to switch to per-person passwords before real enquiries land.	Sam
Decide how people get back in	There is no self-service password reset yet — “Forgot password” tells you to ask an admin. If you want email-based resets, that is a small piece of work we should schedule.	Sam
Who may see Numbers & Routing	It exposes the porting state and routing rules. Admin-only, or everyone?	Sam

5 Confirm what we assumed PLEASE CHECK

These came from the design rather than from you. If any of them is wrong, it is far cheaper to change now than after real leads are in.

WHAT WE ASSUMED	CONFIRM OR CORRECT	WHO
Eight pipeline stages	New enquiry → Contacted → Site photos in → Quote sent → Booked → Job completed → Invoiced → Paid, plus “Lost / no answer”. Does that match how you actually work a job?	Sam or Dan
Job types	Full house, flat void, garden, probate, office strip-out, builders waste, single item. Anything missing, or any you never quote?	Dan
Routing rules	07:00–18:00 rings the office then Sam's mobile; out of hours goes to voicemail with an automatic WhatsApp reply; a missed call sends an SMS within 60 seconds. Correct? Note the app <i>displays</i> these — they are enforced by Aircall's own settings, which we would configure to match.	Sam
First-response target	The inbox flags a new enquiry as overdue after a set time. What is the real target — 30 minutes, an hour, same day?	Sam
Auto-reply wording	What should the automatic missed-call and out-of-hours messages actually say, in your words?	Sam

6 Gaps we have spotted

DECISION NEEDED

Things the design implies that are not built, and that we would need a decision on before quoting them.

GAP	WHAT WE NEED TO KNOW	WHO
Email has no provider	Email is one of the four channels in the design, but Aircall does not carry email. To get <code>hello@c1clearance.co.uk</code> into the same inbox we need a separate integration. Is email a real lead source worth wiring, or is it rare enough to leave out for now?	Sam
Website enquiries	Should the enquiry form on <code>c1clearance.co.uk</code> post straight into the Lead Centre? Right now it goes wherever it goes today.	Sam
“Statto CRM”	Listed as connected in the design for jobs, quotes and invoices. Is that a real system you use, and does it have an API we can talk to?	Sam
Jobs and Settings	Both are in the navigation but not built — they are visibly disabled rather than broken. Worth scoping if you want them.	Sam
Existing leads	Is there a spreadsheet or CRM of current live enquiries to import, or do we start clean from switch-on?	Dan

7 Compliance

BEFORE GO-LIVE

WHAT WE NEED	WHY	WHO
Call recording notice	Calls are recorded and transcribed against each lead. Callers have to be told — usually a short announcement on the line. We need your wording, and confirmation Aircall is set to play it.	Sam
Data retention period	How long do we keep lead records, call recordings and transcripts before deleting them? UK GDPR expects a defined period rather than “forever”.	Sam
Privacy notice	The website's privacy notice should cover what the Lead Centre stores. Who maintains it?	Sam

8 What we still need to build OUR SIDE

Being honest about what is not finished. The first three matter most, because the screens promise things the system cannot yet do.

GAP	WHAT IT MEANS TODAY	PRIORITY
Photos have nowhere to go	"Site photos in" is one of your pipeline stages, and a clearance is quoted off photos. WhatsApp images will arrive at the webhook and be dropped — there is no file storage and no column to hold them. This needs building before photos are part of the real workflow.	High
Call recordings are discarded	The thread shows "Play recording · transcript attached", but nothing is stored behind it. Aircall sends us the recording URL and we currently throw it away. Same for transcripts — they land in the message text rather than a field we can search.	High
Nobody is told when it breaks	There is no error alerting. If the Aircall webhook starts failing — expired token, a payload change — enquiries would stop arriving and the inbox would just look quiet. For a lead system that is the worst possible failure, and it needs monitoring before you rely on it.	High
Everyone sees everything	Admin-only access is written but not applied to any screen, so any signed-in user can see Numbers & Routing. Fine for a team of three; tell us if it should not be.	Medium
No password reset	"Forgot password" tells you to ask an admin. Workable at your size, but worth building if the team grows.	Medium
The lead list loads everything	Every lead comes back in one response. Invisible at eleven leads, slow at a few thousand. Needs paging before a year of enquiries builds up.	Medium
Database backups unconfirmed	Postgres runs on a persistent disk, but we have not yet verified a backup schedule is switched on. Must be confirmed before real customer data lives there.	High
One environment	There is production and nothing else. Changes are tested locally and by automated checks, then deployed straight to live. A staging copy would let you approve changes before customers see them.	Medium
Temporary web address	It currently lives on a hosting-provider URL. Worth pointing something like <code>leads.c1clearance.co.uk</code> at it before the team bookmarks the old one.	Low

Our recommendation

Connect Aircall and start taking real enquiries as soon as the credentials arrive — the inbox works and waiting costs you leads. But treat **photos, recordings and failure alerting** as the immediate next piece of work, not as polish. Without alerting in particular, a broken connection looks exactly like a quiet day.

9 What happens once we have the above

STEP	WHAT WE DO	WHO
1. Connect	Set the Aircall credentials on the server and confirm the webhook is accepted.	Us
2. Test with a real scan	Scan the van QR, send a WhatsApp, place a call, and watch all three land on one lead thread.	Us + Dan
3. Clear the demo data	Wipe the eleven invented leads in one go, so nothing fake is mixed in with real enquiries. After this the data is protected — later releases cannot overwrite it.	Us
4. Set real logins	Create the real staff accounts and retire the shared demo password.	Us
5. Go live	The team works the inbox. Every scan of the van QR arrives here from that moment.	Everyone

The short version

Two things unblock everything else: **a verified Meta Business Portfolio** (start it today — it is the slowest step) and **the Aircall API keys and webhook secret**. With those we can have real enquiries flowing the same day. Everything else on this list can follow while the inbox is already working.